



Delhi Public School, Howrah

PRE-BOARD EXAMINATION - I (2025-26)

SUBJECT: ENGLISH LANGUAGE AND LITERATURE (CODE - 184)

Class- X

Care must be taken not to write anything on the question paper. All the questions must be attempted in the correct sequence.

Time- 3 Hours

Maximum Marks- 80

General instructions:

1. The Question Paper contains THREE sections- Section A - (READING), Section B- (GRAMMAR AND WRITING) and Section C (LITERATURE).
2. Attempt questions based on specific instructions for each part.
3. Separate instructions are given with each section and question, wherever necessary. Read these instructions and follow them.
4. Do not exceed the prescribed word limit while answering the questions.

SECTION A-READING SKILLS (20 marks)

1. Read the following passage:

10

- (1) India's tribal communities have long been the custodians of nature's wisdom. Living close to forests, rivers, and mountains, they have developed a deep understanding of the natural world—one that forms the foundation of traditional healing systems. Their lifestyle, rituals, and medical practices reveal an intimate relationship between human health and the environment. Among the many systems of traditional knowledge in India, Ayurveda shares remarkable similarities with the tribal approach to wellness. Both emphasize harmony with nature, preventive care, and holistic well-being rather than mere treatment of disease.
- (2) Tribal healers, known by different names such as *Vaidus*, *Ojhas*, or *Pahans*, rely on centuries-old herbal knowledge. Their remedies often come from locally available plants—roots, leaves, bark, and fruits—used in carefully balanced combinations. The effectiveness of these treatments, passed down orally through generations, has drawn the attention of modern scientists. Many modern medicines trace their origin to plants that tribal healers used long before they were studied in laboratories. For example, *Rauwolfia serpentina*, used by tribal communities to treat hypertension and anxiety, later became the source of the drug reserpine.
- (3) Ayurveda, which literally means "the science of life," follows similar principles. It views health as a balance between the body, mind, and spirit, and disease as a disturbance of this balance. Like tribal medicine, Ayurveda uses herbs, minerals, diet, and lifestyle practices to restore harmony. Both systems believe that every plant has a purpose and that healing comes not from fighting nature but by aligning with its rhythms. Seasonal routines, herbal tonics, and dietary discipline in Ayurveda echo the tribal understanding of the body's dependence on environmental cycles.
- (4) In recent decades, the connection between tribal knowledge and Ayurveda has gained renewed recognition. Ethnobotanists and Ayurvedic researchers often collaborate with tribal elders to document endangered medicinal traditions. Such efforts not only enrich the Ayurvedic pharmacopoeia but also help preserve India's cultural diversity. However, this exchange must be guided by respect and ethical practices, ensuring that tribal communities receive credit and benefit for their contributions.
- (5) Tribal culture and Ayurveda together remind us that health is not merely the absence of illness but a state of equilibrium—between the human being and the natural world. In their shared wisdom lies a powerful message for

modern society: progress must not come at the cost of the planet's balance or the loss of ancestral knowledge that sustains life itself.

Answer the following questions, based on the passage above.

- I. Why is the connection between tribal healing and Ayurveda considered vital in today's world? 1
- II. According to paragraph 2, the remedies used by tribal healers possess all of the following features EXCEPT: 1
- A. Locally sourced ingredients
 - B. Oral transmission of knowledge
 - C. Dependence on synthetic chemicals
 - D. Centuries-old use
- III. Complete the following by selecting the correct option from those given in brackets. 1
- The phrase "*carefully balanced combinations*" in paragraph 2 suggests that tribal medicine relies on _____.
(precision / experimentation / secrecy)
- IV. Select the option that is TRUE from (A)–(C) given below for what the phrase "*restoring harmony*" implies in paragraph 3. 1
- A. Healing the mind and body in isolation.
 - B. Treating symptoms through modern drugs only.
 - C. Bringing the body, mind, and nature into balance.
- V. Complete the analogy by selecting one of the options: 1
- Tribal healers : oral tradition :: Ayurvedic physicians : _____
- A. classical texts
 - B. ritual offerings
 - C. environmental cycles
 - D. dietary drugs
- VI. Ayurveda views health as a balance between the body, mind, and spirit, and disease as a disturbance of this balance. Explain any one way as to how one can achieve that. 2
- VII. Which of the following conveys the main idea/ideas of paragraph 4? 1
- 1- ~~Ayurveda depends entirely on forest plants.~~
 - 2- Ayurveda depends entirely on forest plants. ✗
 - 3- Documentation of tribal remedies enriches Ayurveda. ✓✓
 - 4- Ayurveda and tribal culture are in conflict. ✗
 - 5- Modern science dismisses traditional healing.
 - 6- Preserving Ayurveda implies preserving India's heritage. ✓
- A. Option 1, 2, and 4
 - B. Option 3 and 6
 - C. Option 3, 5 and 6
 - D. Option 3 only.
- VIII. Why is it essential for modern society to respect and preserve tribal knowledge systems alongside Ayurveda? 2

2. Read the following passage:

10

- (1) A comprehensive survey conducted among 250 students aged 13–18 examined evolving patterns in music streaming, focusing on platform preference, listening habits, and motivational factors. The objective was to understand how accessibility, personalization, and peer influence shape contemporary listening behaviour among adolescents.
- (2) The findings revealed that 70% of respondents preferred Spotify as their main streaming platform, citing its algorithmic recommendations, mood-based playlists, and interface design as significant advantages. 20% favoured YouTube Music, largely for its free access and visual content, while 10% used regional apps such as Gaana or Wynk for vernacular music. Younger teens (13–15 years) reported shorter listening durations—averaging 1.5 hours per day—primarily during study or leisure time, whereas older students (16–18 years) spent up to 4 hours

daily, often integrating music into multitasking routines such as workouts or commuting.

- (3) Genre preference displayed distinct variations. For academic or relaxation purposes, 52% opted for instrumental, lo-fi, or acoustic tracks. During travel or social activities, 66% preferred energetic genres like pop, rap, and EDM, while 18% enjoyed classical or regional compositions. Notably, 58% of participants discovered new music through algorithmic suggestions, compared to 27% who relied on peer recommendations via social media, indicating the rising dominance of digital curation over traditional word-of-mouth.
- (4)* The analysis underscores how streaming platforms have reshaped music discovery and identity among youth, fostering both diversity and dependence on algorithmic personalization. To maintain engagement, platforms could integrate community-based discovery features and ethical recommendation systems that balance popular and independent artists. This prevents algorithmic bias and promotes diversity. Such systems would enhance trust, user satisfaction, and fairness in music discovery. This shift highlights a broader cultural movement—where technology, creativity, and connectivity converge to redefine how the younger generation experiences music.

Answer the following questions, based on the passage above.

- I. Why did the study most likely focus on teenagers aged 13–18? 1
This is so because this age group ____
A. represents the most active digital users.
B. has access to formal training in music.
C. is less exposed to social media influence.
D. mostly prefers traditional forms of music.
- II. Rhea, aged 17, wants to create a calming study playlist. She is most likely to select instrumental or lo-fi tracks because the ____ (genre / platform) mentioned in the passage helps students maintain focus and relaxation. 1
- III. What does the writer mean by “algorithmic recommendations”, as used in paragraph 2? 2
- IV. Complete the sentence with the most appropriate option. 1
When the writer says that “genre preference displayed distinct variations”, it means that —
A. all age groups liked the same kind of music.
B. students’ choices differed based on purpose and activity.
C. older teens preferred no background music.
D. instrumental music dominated across every age group.
- V. The one likely reason older students (16–18 years) listened longer each day is because ____ 1
A. they had more access to premium accounts.
B. they multitasked while listening to music.
C. they had fewer school hours.
D. they were preparing for exams.
- VI. In the context of the passage, “the rising dominance of digital curation over traditional word-of-mouth” suggests a relationship similar to: 1
A. excitement : boredom
B. innovation : stagnation
C. influence : submission
D. control : freedom
- VII. Elaborate on how ethical recommendation systems could enhance user experience, according to the writer. 2
- VIII. Fill in the blank with ONE suitable word. 1
Understanding youth-specific listening patterns helps platforms design features that cater to a wide range of musical preferences, ensuring their services remain both relevant and ____.

SECTION B: WRITING SKILLS & GRAMMAR (20 marks)
GRAMMAR

(10)

3. Complete any ten of the following twelve tasks, as directed.

- I. Fill in the blank with the correct form of the word in brackets for the given portion of a market research:
The new educational app is highly _____(engage), ensuring that students remain focused during learning activities.
- II. Identify the error and write the correction in the given sentence spoken by a general manager.

He is one of those employees who works with complete dedication.

Use the given format.

Error	Correction

- III. Fill in the blank with the correct form of the verb given in the brackets.
If she _____(be) in charge, the project would have been completed months ago.
- IV. Read the given statement and report it correctly by completing the sentence.
Riya says, "I have been practising for the competition for months."
Riya says that _____
- V. Fill in the blank by choosing the correct option to complete the conclusion of a business letter:
Please ensure that all future correspondence is made in strict _____ with our company's policy.
- A. accordance
B. accordance to
C. according
D. accordingly
- VI. Report the following question by completing the reported sentence correctly.
"When did you submit the project proposal?" the teacher asked Rohan.
Reported: The teacher asked Rohan _____
- VII. The inspiring lecture helped the students _____ motivated to participate in the debate.
- A. having remained
B. remaining
C. remain
D. remains
- VIII. The given question has an error. Select the option that correctly identifies the error and the correction.
Regular outbreaks of water-borne epidemics and an increasing number of patients been admitted to hospitals due to water-related diseases indicate poor sanitation facilities in the area.

Options.	Error	Correction
A.	epidemics	epidemic
B.	increasing	increased
C.	been	being
D.	indicate	indicates

- IX. Report the following request.
The mother said to her son, "Please join us for the trip this year."
- X. Fill in the blank with the correct option from those given in the brackets.
He _____(dare/dares) not speak against the manager, even if he knew the truth.
- XI. Fill in the blank to complete the sentence taken from a minute of the meeting, by choosing the correct option.
_____ of the members in the council was present at the meeting yesterday.
- A. All
B. Each

- C. Some
- D. Few

XII. Choose the correct option to fill the blank.

She brought along _____ ingredients for the recipe, yet it was enough to cook a delicious meal.

- A. little
- B. few
- C. some
- D. any

WRITING

4A. You are Ritika Sharma, the Cultural Secretary of your school and you feel that traditional art forms are losing their relevance among students today. You believe schools should take an active role in reviving these fading traditions. Write a letter to the Director of School Education in your city, in about 120 words, emphasizing the importance of preserving traditional art forms and suggesting ways schools can integrate them into the curriculum and co-curricular activities. 5

OR

4B. You are Sneha Rao, the Secretary of your school's Health and Wellness Club and you are alarmed by the rising cases of stress, anxiety, and burnout among students due to academic pressure and digital overload. Write a letter to the Editor of a national daily, in about 120 words, expressing your concern about the declining mental well-being of students. Emphasize the importance of emotional resilience, mindfulness, and balanced study routines, and suggest practical initiatives schools can adopt to promote mental health awareness and support systems. 5

5A. You are the President of the Literary Society of your school. Two guest authors — Mr. Arvind Nair and Ms. Kavita Deshmukh — have written to express their interest in participating in your school's Annual Literary Conclave. Below are excerpts from their letters. 5

Excerpt 1:

...I would be honoured to participate as a guest speaker in your school's Literary Conclave. As an author of several contemporary novels and a mentor for young writers, I focus on nurturing creativity through language. My workshops highlight the importance of storytelling as a medium for self-expression and cultural connection. I have conducted sessions in schools and literary festivals across the country, helping students explore writing beyond textbooks. I believe my presence can help your students understand the power of words in shaping thought and empathy.

Best regards,

Mr. Arvind Nair

Excerpt 2:

...It would be a pleasure to be a part of your Literary Conclave as a guest author. Having written for both print and digital media, I have explored how writing adapts to the changing world. My sessions revolve around the print-media which is gaining a wider reach for the audience now. I particularly enjoy interacting with young readers and guiding them to find their unique voice in the world of journalism. I look forward to sharing my experiences and discussing how writing continues to evolve with technology and social change.

Yours sincerely,

Ms. Kavita Deshmukh

Analyse the information in a paragraph, justifying which participant would be a better choice for a Literary Event.

OR

5B. Riya, Class X, is known for her curiosity, creativity, and problem-solving skills. She enjoys taking initiative and bringing innovative ideas to group projects. However, she sometimes gets absorbed in ideation and struggles to manage time effectively. She has to work on a STEM exhibition project and must choose a partner from Nikhil, Sanya, and Dev. Below are the profiles of the three candidates. 5

Nikhil: Nikhil is methodical and analytical, with a strong grasp of scientific concepts. He works best when following a clear plan and is known for his punctuality and precision. However, he tends to be overly cautious and may hesitate to experiment with unconventional ideas.
Sanya: Sanya is energetic and outgoing, with excellent communication and presentation skills. She brings enthusiasm to the team and enjoys brainstorming. However, she sometimes overlooks small details and needs reminders to stay on schedule.
Dev: Dev is quiet but extremely dependable. He is skilled in research and data interpretation and ensures accuracy in every aspect of the project. However, he finds it difficult to express ideas confidently in front of an audience.

Based on the features of each candidate, analyse and decide who would be the best partner for Riya. Consider aspects such as complementary strengths, teamwork, and the project's requirements.

SECTION C: LITERATURE TEXTBOOK (40 marks)

6. Read the given extracts A and B and answer ANY ONE of the two. 5

A. This wish became stronger and stronger, until it was an overwhelming desire. Valli would stare wistfully at the people who got on or off the bus when it stopped at the street corner. Their faces would kindle in her longings, dreams, and hopes. If one of her friends happened to ride the bus and tried to describe the sights of the town to her, Valli would be too jealous to listen and would shout, in English: "Proud! proud!"

- I. Contradict the view that Valli's fascination with the bus ride was merely childish curiosity. 2
- II. What does Valli's response- "Proud! proud!" - to her friends' descriptions of the town reveal about her reaction? 1
- A. She used the word "proud" without grasping its true meaning, reflecting her childlike imitation of adults.
 - B. She deliberately used the word to mock her friends' behaviour.
 - C. She used "proud" to express genuine appreciation for their adventurous spirit.
 - D. She disliked English words and used them only to tease others.
- III. What can be inferred about Valli's character from her reaction when her friends described the town? 1
- IV. Read the following words from the extract and identify which belong to the *emotion* and *action* categories: 1
- i) stare ii) kindle iii) longings iv) shout v) listen

Options.	EMOTION	ACTION
A.	iii	i, ii, iv, v
B.	iii	i, ii, v
C.	ii, iv	i, ii, iii, v
D.	i, iii	ii, iv, v

B. THINK-TANK: Mirror, mirror, in my hand. Who is the most fantastically intellectually gifted being in the land?
OFFSTAGE VOICE: (after a pause) You, sir.
THINK -TANK: (smacking mirror) Quicker. Answer quicker next time. I hate a slow mirror. (He admires himself in the mirror.) Ah, there I am. Are we Martians not a handsome race? So much more attractive than those ugly Earthlings

with their tiny heads. Noodle, you keep on exercising your mind, and someday you'll have a balloon brain just like mine.

NOODLE: Oh, I hope so, Mighty Think-Tank. I hope so.

THINK-TANK: Now, contact the space probe. I want to invade that primitive ball of mud called Earth before lunch.

NOODLE: It shall be done, sir. (He adjusts levers on switchboard. Electronic buzzes and beeps are heard as the curtains open.)

I. What is the primary purpose of the parentheses in the given extract?

1

- A. To provide additional background information about the plot
- B. To show the stage directions that guide actors' actions and timing
- C. To include the playwright's personal commentary on the events
- D. To mark optional lines that may be skipped in performance

II. "Mirror, mirror, in my hand. Who is the most fantastically intellectually gifted being in the land?"

1

Choose the option that lists the genre having the original reference to the above lines.

- A. Biography
- B. Science-fiction
- C. Mystery
- D. Fairy tale

III. Below is a comment from a critic. Complete the same by choosing the correct word from the given options that complements the given extract:

1

Think-Tank's _____ (i) self-admiration is deeply ironic—he demands praise from a mirror, scolds it for hesitation, and _____ (ii) Earthlings' appearance, completely unaware that his own _____ (iii) pomposity makes him the true object of _____ (iv).

- A. (i) modest (ii) admires (iii) reasonable (iv) admiration
- B. (i) subtle (ii) respects (iii) hidden (iv) envy
- C. (i) exaggerated (ii) mocks (iii) absurd (iv) ridicule
- D. (i) fleeting (ii) ignores (iii) delicate (iv) attention

IV. What prompts Noodle to be polite and submissive in his interactions with Think-Tank?

1

- A. Noodle is naturally timid and lacks confidence.
- B. Noodle is impressed by Think-Tank's intelligence and wealth.
- C. Noodle responds to Think-Tank's arrogance and fears punishment.
- D. Noodle is one of those boot-lickers who flatter for the sake of personal gains.

V. Choose the option that includes the display of 'smacking' as used in the extract.

1



A



B



C



D

7. Read the given extracts A and B and answer ANY ONE of the two

5

A. Belinda was as brave as a barrel full of bears,
And Ink and Blink chased lions down the stairs,
Mustard was as brave as a tiger in a rage,
But Custard cried for a nice safe cage.
Suddenly, suddenly they heard a nasty sound,
And Mustard growled, and they all looked around.

Meowch! cried Ink, and ooh! cried Belinda,
For there was a pirate, climbing in the winda.

1

I. Which figure of speech is NOT used in the given extract?

- A. Alliteration
- B. Hyperbole
- C. Metaphor
- D. Simile

2

II. Justify the use of the word 'winda' in place of 'window'?

1

III. Complete the analogy based on the events that follow:

Ink: terrified: : Blink: petrified : : Pirate: _____ :: Custard: _____

- A. valiant, brave
- B. stunned, valiant
- C. shocked, timid
- D. stunned, shocked

1

IV. Fill in the blank with a phrase to suitably complete the sentence.

The poem is a ballad written in the style of a _____

B. I sit inside, doors open to the veranda
writing long letters
in which I scarcely mention the departure
of the forest from the house.
The night is fresh, the whole moon shines
in a sky still open
the smell of leaves and lichen
still reaches like a voice into the rooms.

I. The extract uses 'open' twice, suggesting different meanings. In which of the following sentences is the word "open" used in the same sense as in "the sky still open" from the extract?

1

- A. She left the window open to let in the cool breeze.
- B. The meadow lay open, bathed in golden sunlight.
- C. He kept his heart open to new ideas.
- D. The shop was open for business all day.

II. The forest has "departed" but its smell still reaches the rooms. This suggests:

1

- A. Nature's presence can linger in memory and senses even after it is gone
- B. The forest has literally returned
- C. The speaker is imagining the forest
- D. Nature is permanent and cannot disappear

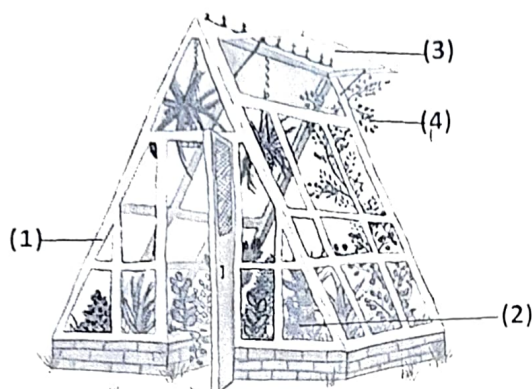
III. Which literary device in "the smell of leaves and lichen still reaches like a voice into the rooms" enhances eco-feminist understanding of the poem?

1

- A. Hyperbole – exaggerates the smell of nature
- B. Simile – conveys the enduring presence and voice of nature
- C. Metaphor – compares rooms to forests
- D. Irony – mocks environmental awareness

IV. Study the picture below and explain what '1' stands for, based on your understanding of the poem.

2



8. Answer ANY FOUR of the following five questions, in about 50 words each.

4x3=12

- I. What do the theories about the Kodavus' origins reveal about the cultural diversity and historical interactions that shaped Coorg's identity?
- II. Besides Gautama Buddha, the "lights of the city" also guide Kisa Gotami toward enlightenment. Explain how this imagery contributes to her realization.
- III. How does 'The Proposal' humorously nullify the concept of marriage as an important decision?
- IV. 'The field was white, as if covered with salt.' The pelting hailstones could have been easily seen as sugar cubes. Why does the author choose 'salt' instead of 'sugar cubes' while describing the scene?
- V. The poet describes the tiger as "*stalking the length of his cage, ignoring visitors*" in the poem 'The Tiger in the Zoo'. Illustrate this act as a passive acceptance of his captivity.

9. Answer ANY TWO of the following three questions, in about 40-50 words.

2x3=6

- I. Give a brief insight into Richard Ebright's character from the perspective of Mr Weiherer.
- II. The lady's calm confidence contrasts with Horace's careful nervousness. What does this reversal of expected traits suggest about appearances and intelligence in the story 'A Question of Trust'?
- III. "When the train had gone, I found myself standing alone on the deserted platform."- This marks the profound moment in Hari's life. What realization has he been led to?

10. Answer ANY ONE of the following two questions, in about 100-120 words

1 x 6

A. How does literature like "*Mijbil the Otter*" contribute to promoting awareness about animals, and the importance of pet care?

OR

B. How do the poems "*Amanda*" by Robin Klein and "*For Anne Gregory*" by ^{W.B. Yeats} ~~Judith Wright~~ portray the influence of elders on young individuals, and what does this reveal about the complexities of guidance, autonomy, and identity formation?

11. Answer ANY ONE of the following two questions, in about 100-120 words

1 x 6

A. *The Necklace* and *Footprints Without Feet* explore the themes of responsibility and accountability. Compare how Mathilda's desire for social status in *The Necklace* and Griffin's experiments in *The Footprints Without Feet* result in suffering for themselves and others.

OR

B. How does the cow metaphor deepen the reader's understanding of societal attitudes toward girls and women in the story 'Bholi'?